

guiltlesse: for thou art a wise man, and knowest what thou oughtest to doe vnto him, but his hoare head hung thou downe to the graue with blood.

10 So * Dauid slept with his fathers, and was buried in the crie of Dauid.

11 And the dayes that Dauid * raigned ouer Israel, were fourty yeeres: seuen yeeres raigned hee in hebron, and thirty and thre yeeres raigned hee in Ierusalem.

12 ¶ Then sate Solomon vpon the throne of Dauid his father, and his kingdome was established greedily.

13 ¶ And Adoniah the sonne of Hagith came to Bathsheba the mother of Solomon, and she said, Comiest thou peaceably: And he said, Peaceably.

14 He said moreover, I haue some what to say vnto thee. And she saide, Say on.

15 And he said, Thou knowest that the kingdome was mine, and that all Israel set their faces on me, that I should raigne: howbeit the kingdome is turned about, and is become my brothers: for it was his from the LORD.

16 And now I aske one petition of thee, † deny me not. And she saide vnto him, Say on.

17 And hee saide, Speake, I pray thee, vnto Solomon the king (for hee will not say thee nay) that he giue me Abishag the Shunammite to wife.

18 And Bathsheba said, Wel, I will speake for thee vnto the king.

19 ¶ Bathsheba therefore went vnto king Solomon, to speake vnto him for Adoniah: and the king rose vp to meete her, and bowed himselfe vnto her, and sate downe on his throne, and caused a seate to bee set for the Kings mother, and she sate on his right hand.

20 Then she said, I desire one small petition of thee, I pray thee say me not nay: and the King said vnto her, Aske on, my mother, for I will not say thee nay.

21 And she saide, Let Abishag the Shunammite be giuen to Adoniah thy brother to wife.

22 And king Solomon answered, and said vnto his mother, And why dost thou aske Abishag the Shunammite for Adoniah: Aske for him the kingdome also (for he is mine elder brother) euen for him, and for Abiathar the Priest, & for Joab the sonne of Zeruiah.

23 Then king Solomon sware by the LORD, saying, God doe so to me, and more also, if Adoniah haue not spoken this word against his owne life.

24 Now therefore as the LORD liueth, which hath established mee, and set mee on the throne of Dauid my father, and who hath made me an house as he * promised, Adoniah shall be put to death this day.

25 And king Solomon sent by the hand of Benaiah the sonne of Jehoiada, and he fell vpon him that he died.

26 ¶ And vnto Abiathar the Priest saide the King, Set thee to Anathoth, vnto thine owne fields, for thou art † worthy of death: but I will not at this time put thee to death, because thou barest the arke of the Lord GOD before Dauid my father, and because thou hast bene afflicted in all wherein my father was afflicted.

27 So Solomon thrust out Abiathar from being Priest vnto the LORD: that hee might * fulfill the word of the LORD, which hee spake concerning the house of Eli in Shiloh.

28 ¶ Then tidings came to Joab (for Joab had turned after Adoniah, though hee turned not after Abisalom) and Joab fled vnto the Tabernacle of the LORD, and caught hold on the hornes of the Altar.

29 And it was told king Solomon that Joab was fled vnto the Tabernacle of the LORD, and behold, hee is by the Altar: Then Solomon sent Benaiah the sonne of Jehoiada, saying, Goe fall vpon him.

30 And Benaiah came to the Tabernacle of the LORD, and said vnto him, Thus saith the king, Come forth. And he said, Nay, but I will die heere. And Benaiah brought the king word againe, saying, Thus said Joab, and thus he answered me.

31 And the king saide vnto him, Doe as he hath said, and fall vpon him, and bury him, that thou mayest take away the innocent blood which Joab shed, from mee, and from the house of my father.

32 And the LORD shall retuene his blood vpon his owne head, who fell vpon two men, more righteous and better then hee, and slew them with the sword, my father Dauid not knowing thereof, to wit, * Abner the sonne of Ner, captaine of the hoste of Israel, and

* Act 1
19. and 13
36

* 2 Sam. 5. 4
1 Chron. 29
26, 27.

* 2 Chron.
29. 23.

* 2 Sam. 7.
12, 13.

† Heb. a man
of death.

* 1. Sam. 2.
31, 35.

† Heb. turne
not away
my face.

* 2 Sam.
3. 27.

* 2 Sam. 20.
10.

* Amasa the sonne of Jether, captaine of the hoste of Iudah.

33 Their blood shall therefore re-
turne vpon the head of Joab, and vpon
the head of his seed for euer: but vpon
Dauid, and vpon his seed, and vpon
his house, and vpon his throne,
shall there bee peace for euer from the
LORD.

34 So Benaiah the sonne of Jeho-
iada went vp, and fell vpon him, and
slewe him, and hee was buried in his
owne house in the wilbernesse.

35 And the king put Benaiah the
sonne of Jehoiada in his roome ouer
the hoste, and Zadok the Priest did the
king put in the roome of Abiathar.

36 And the king sent, and called
for Shimei, and said vnto him, Build
thee an house in Ierusalem, and dwell
there, and goe not forth thence any whi-
ther.

37 For it shall be, that on the day
thou goest out, & passest ouer the brooke
Kidron, thou shalt know for certaine,
that thou shalt surely die: thy blood shall
be vpon thine owne head.

38 And Shimei said vnto the King,
The saying is good: as my lord the king
hath said, so will thy seruant doe. And
Shimei dwelt in Ierusalem many
dayes.

39 And it came to passe at the end of
three yeeres, that two of the seruants
of Shimei ranne away vnto Achish
sonne of Maachah king of Gath: and
they told Shimei, saying, Beholde, thy
seruants be in Gath.

40 And Shimei arose, and saddled
his asse, and went to Gath to Achish,
to seeke his seruants: and Shimei went
and brought his seruants from Gath.

41 And it was told Solomon, that
Shimei had gone from Ierusalem to
Gath, and was come againe.

42 And the king sent and called for
Shimei, and said vnto him, Did I not
make thee to sweare by the LORD,
and protested vnto thee, saying, Know
for a certaine, that on the day thou goest
out, and walkest abroad any whither,
that thou shalt surely die: And thou
saidest vnto me, The word that I haue
heard, is good.

43 Why then hast thou not kept the
Oath of the LORD, and the com-
mandement that I haue charged thee
with?

44 The king said moreouer to Shimei,

mei, Thou knowest all the wickednesse
which thine heart is priue to, that thou
diddest to Dauid my father: therefore
the LORD shall returne thy wicked-
nesse vpon thine owne head.

45 And king Salomon shall be ble-
sed, and the throne of Dauid shall bee
established before the LORD for euer.

46 So the king commaunded Be-
naiah the sonne of Jehoiada, which
went out, and fell vpon him, that hee di-
ed, and the kingdom was established
in the hand of Solomon.

* 2 Chron.
1.1.

CHAP. III.

1 Solomon marieth Pharaohs daughter. 2 His
places being in vse, Solomon sacrificeth at Gi-
beon. 3 Solomon at Gibeon, in the choice
which God gaue him, preferring wisdom,
obtaineth wisdom, riches, and honour.
16 Solomons iudgement betwene the two
harlots, maketh him renowned.

SOLOMON made
an affinitie with Pharaoh
king of Egypt, and tooke
Pharaohs daughter, and
brought her into the citie
of Dauid, vntill he had made an end of
building his owne house, and the house
of the LORD, and the wall of Ieru-
salem round about.

* Chap. 7.8

2 Only the people sacrificed in high
places, because there was no house
built vnto the Name of the LORD
vntill those dayes.

3 And Solomon loued the LORD,
walking in the statutes of Dauid his
father: onely he sacrificed and burnt in-
cense in high places.

4 And the king went to Gibeon to
sacrifice there: for that was the great
high place: a thousand burnt offerings
did Solomon offer vpon that Altar.

5 In Gibeon the LORD appea-
red to Solomon in a dreame by night:
and God sayd, Aske what I shall giue
thee.

6 And Solomon said, Thou hast
shewed vnto thy seruant Dauid my fa-
ther great mercy, according as he wal-
ked before thee in truth, and in righte-
ousnesse, and in vprightness of heart
with thee, and thou hast kept for him
this great kindnesse, that thou hast ge-
uen him a sonne to sit on his throne, as
it is this day.

Or, bonitie.

7 And now, O LORD my God,
thou hast made thy seruant King in
stead

stead of Dauid my father : and I am but a litle childe : I know not how to goe out or come in.

8 And thy seruant is in the midst of thy people which thou hast chosen, a great people, that cannot be numbred, nor counted for multitude.

9 * Giue therefore thy seruant an vnderstanding heart, to iudge thy people, that I may discerne betwene good and bad: for who is able to iudge this thy so great a people?

10 And the speech pleased the LORD, that Solomon had asked this thing.

11 And God said vnto him, Because thou hast asked this thing, and hast not asked for thy selfe long life, neither hast asked riches for thy selfe, nor hast asked the life of thine enemies, but hast asked for thy selfe vnderstanding to discerne iudgement;

12 Behold, I haue done according to thy word: loe, I haue giuen thee a wise and an vnderstanding heart, so that there was none like thee before thee, neither after thee shall any arise like vnto thee.

13 And I haue also * giuen thee that which thou hast not asked, both riches, and honour: so that there shall not be any among the Kings like vnto thee, all thy dayes.

14 And if thou wilt walke in my wayes, to keepe my Statutes and my Commandements, * as thy father Dauid did walke, then I will lengthen thy dayes.

15 And Solomon awoke, and behold, it was a dreame: and he came to Ierusalem, and stood before the Arke of the Couenant of the LORD, and offered by burnt offerings, and offered peace offerings, and made a feast to all his seruants.

16 ¶ Then came there two women that were harlots, vnto the king, and stood before him.

17 And the one woman said, O my lord, I and this woman dwell in one house, and I was deliuered of a childe, with her in the house.

18 And it came to passe the third day after that I was deliuered, that this woman was deliuered also: and wee were together; there was no stranger with vs in the house, saue we two in the house.

19 And this womans childe died in the night: because she overlaid it.

20 And shee arose at midnight, and tooke my sonne from beside me, while thine handmaid slept, and layd it in her bosome, and layd her dead childe in my bosome.

21 And when I rose in the morning to giue my childe sucke, behold, it was dead: but when I had considered it in the morning, beholde, it was not my sonne, which I did beare.

22 And the other woman said, Nay, but the liuing is my sonne, and the dead is thy sonne: And this said, No, but the dead is thy sonne, and the liuing is my sonne. Thus they spake before the king.

23 Then said the King, The one saith, This is my sonne, that liueth, and thy sonne is the dead: and the other saith, Nay: but thy sonne is the dead, and my sonne is the liuing.

24 And the King said, Bring mee a sword. And they brought a sword before the king:

25 And the king said, Diuide the liuing childe in two, and giue halfe to the one, and halfe to the other.

26 Then spake the woman whose the liuing childe was, vnto the king, (for her bowels were yerned vpon her sonne) and she said, O my lord, giue her the liuing childe, and in no wise slay it: But the other said, Let it be neither mine nor thine, but diuide it.

27 Then the King answered and said, Giue her the liuing child, and in no wise slay it: she is the mother thereof.

28 And all Israel heard of the Iudgement which the king had iudged, and they feared the King: for they saw that the wisdom of God was in him, to doe Iudgement.

CHAP. IIII.

1 Solomons Princes. 7 His twelue Officers for prouision. 20. 24 The peace and largesse of his kingdome. 22 His daily prouision. 26 His stables. 29 His wisdom.

¶ King Solomon was king ouer all Israel.

2 And these were the Princes which he had, Azariah the sonne of Zadok, the Priest,

3 Elihozeoph, and Ahiah the sonnes of Shisha, Scribes: Ichothaphat the sonne of Ahilud the Recorder;

4 And Benaiah the sonne of Jehoiada was ouer the host: And Zadok

and

* 2. Chron. 1. 10.
† Hebr. hearing.

† Hebr. many dayes.

† Hebr. so beare.

* Matth. 6. 33. wised. 7. 11.
|| Or, hath not bene.

* Chap. 15. 5.

† Hebr. were hot.

† Hebr. in the midst of him.

|| Or, the chiefe Officer.
|| Or, Secretaries.
|| Or, remembrancer.

Solomons officers, I.Kings. and prouision.

and Abiathar were the Priests :

5 And Azariah the sonne of Nathan was ouer the officers : and Zabud the sonne of Nathan was principall officer, and the kings friend.

6 And Abiathar was ouer the household : and * Adoniram the sonne of Adad was ouer the tribute.

7 And Solomon had twelue officers ouer all Israel, which prouided victuals for the king and his household : each man his moneth in a peece made prouision.

8 And these are their names : || the sonne of Hur in mount Ephraim,

9 The || sonne of Dekar in Makaz, and in Shalbun, and Bethhemesh, and Elon-Bethhanan.

10 The || sonne of Heseb in Aruboth, to him pertained Sorchoh, and all the land of Hepher ;

11 The || sonne of Abinadab in all the region of Dor, which had Eaphath the daughter of Solomon to wife :

12 Baana the sonne of Ahilab, to him pertained Taanach and Megiddo, and all Beth-shean, which is by Zartanah beneath Jezreel, from Beth-shean to Abel-Meholah, euen vnto the place that is beyond Jokneam :

13 The || sonne of Geber in Ramoth Gilead, to him pertained the towynes of Jair the sonne of Manasseh, which are in Gilead : to him also pertained the region of Argob, which is in Bashan, threescore great cities, with walles, and brasen barres.

14 Abinadab the sonne of Jodo had Mahanaim.

15 Ahumaz was in Naphtali : he also tooke Basmath the daughter of Solomon to wife.

16 Baanah the sonne of Hushai was in Asher and in Aloth :

17 Jehoshaphat the sonne of Paruah in Issachar :

18 Shimei the sonne of Elah in Benjamin :

19 Geber the sonne of Uri was in the countrey of Gilead, in the countrey of Sihon king of the Amorites, and of Og king of Bashan ; and hee was the onely officer which was in the land.

20 And Judah and Israel were many, as the land which is by the sea in multitude, eating and drinking and making merrie.

21 And * Solomon reigned ouer all kingdoms from the riuer vnto the land

of the Philistines, and vnto the border of Egypt : they brought presents, and serued Solomon all the dayes of his life.

22 And Solomons [†] prouision for one day, was thirtie measures of fine floure, and threescore [†] measures of meale,

23 Ten fat oxen, and twentie oxen out of the pastures, and an hundred sheepe, beside harts, and Roe-bucks, and fallow Deere, and fatted soule.

24 For he had dominion ouer all the region on this side the Riuer, from Tiph-sah euen to Azzah ouer all the kings on this side the Riuer : and he had peace on all sides round about him.

25 And Judah and Israel dwelt [†] safely, euery man vnder his Vine, and vnder his Figtree, from Dan euen to Beer-sheba, all the dayes of Solomon.

26 And * Solomon had fourtie thousand stables of horses for his charrets, and twelue thousand horsemen.

27 And those officers prouided victuall for king Solomon, and for all that came vnto king Solomons table, euery man in his moneth : they lacked nothing.

28 Barley also and straw for the horses and || dromedaries, brought they vnto the place where the officers were, euery man according to his charge.

29 And * God gaue Solomon wisdom, and vnderstanding, exceeding much, and largenesse of heart, euen as the sand that is on the sea shoare.

30 And Solomons wisdom excelled the wisdom of all the children of the East countrey, and all the wisdom of Egypt.

31 For hee was wiser then all men ; then Ethan the Ezrahite, and Heman, and Chalcol, and Darda the sonnes of Bahol : and his fame was in all nations round about.

32 And he spake three thousand prouerbes : and his songs were a thousand and five.

33 And hee spake of trees, from the Cedar tree that is in Lebanon, euen vnto the hyssope that springeth out of the wall : hee spake also of beasts, and of foule, and of creeping things, and of fishes.

34 And there came of all people to heare the wisdom of Solomon, from all kings of the earth, which had heard of his wisdom.

[†] Heb. bread.

[†] Heb. Cor.

[†] Heb. confidently.

* 2. Chron. 9. 25.

|| Or, mules, or swift beasts.

* Eccles. 47. 14. 15. 16.

* Chap. 5. 14. Or, leuie.

Or, Ben-hur.

Or, Ben-Dekar.

Or, Ben-Heseb.

Or, Ben-Abinadab.

Or, Ben-Geber.

Or, to Mahanaim.

* Eccles. 47. 15.